

PLANRS ACADEMY

Mastering Measurement: Grade 3 Mathematics

AREA

Counting Squares & Formula

Session 1: The Tile Master

Choosing the Perfect Rug!

Ishaan wants to buy a colorful rug for his bedroom, but he has a problem. He doesn't know how to choose the right size! He wonders how much of the floor the rug will cover. Today, we're going to help Ishaan become a Tile Master and solve the mystery of space!

Our Building Goals

In this lesson, we will build our skills to:

- **Define Area:** Understand that it's the amount of "space inside" a shape.
- **Count the Tiles:** Learn how to find area by counting unit squares.
- **Discover the Shortcut:** Use a simple formula to find area quickly.
- **Compare Borders and Surfaces:** Know the difference between Perimeter and Area.

THE GRID MYSTERY:

Look at your math notebook with the small squares. How many of those squares would your hand cover if you laid it flat? That's what Area is all about!

What Is Area?

Area is a way to measure the "surface" of a flat shape. It tells us how much room something takes up on the ground or on a wall.

Definition: Area is the amount of space covered by a flat (2D) shape.

The Park Analogy

Think of your colony park:

- **Perimeter** is the fence that goes around the park.
- **Area** is the green grass inside the fence where you play cricket or football.



Counting Squares: The First Step

The easiest way to measure area is to see how many equal-sized "unit squares" can fit inside a shape.

The Barfi Tray Example

Imagine a delicious tray of Barfi from the local Mithai shop. The tray is filled with square pieces of Barfi.

- If there are 4 rows of Barfi...
- And each row has 5 pieces...
- We can count them: 1, 2, 3... all the way to 20!

Because the tray fits 20 pieces perfectly, we say the **Area of the tray is 20 square units.**

1	2	3	4	5
6				
	4 Rows × 5 Columns			
				20

From Counting to Multiplying!

Counting 100 squares one by one takes a long time! Is there a faster way? Yes! We can use Multiplication.

The Shortcut

Instead of counting every single square, we just need to know two things:

1. How many squares are in one row? (This is the **Length**)
2. How many rows are there? (This is the **Width**)

THE MATH TRICK:

If a rectangle has 4 rows and 5 columns, we multiply: $4 \times 5 = 20$ square units.

The Area Formula

As Tile Masters, we can now use a "Secret Formula" to find the space inside any rectangle or square instantly.

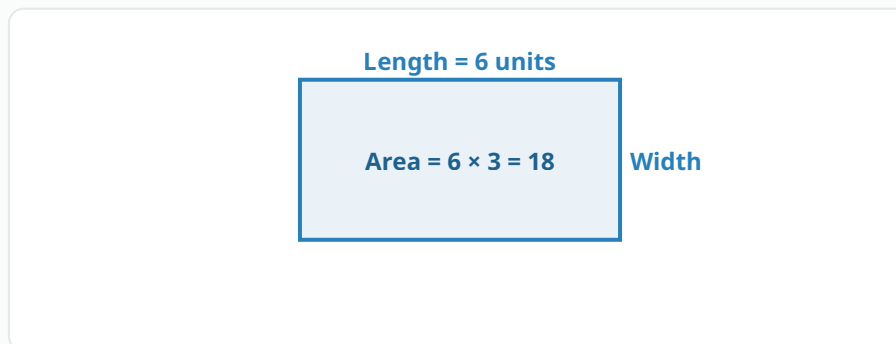
$$\text{Area} = \text{Length} \times \text{Width}$$

Worked Example: The Yoga Mat

Imagine your mother's Yoga Mat or a picnic Chatai.

- Length: 6 units

- Width: 3 units
- Area = $6 \times 3 = 18$ square units



Area vs. Perimeter: What's the Difference?

It's very easy to get these two mixed up! Let's look at them side-by-side:

Feature	Perimeter	Area
What is it?	The Distance Around	The Space Inside
Example	A Garden Fence	The Grass Inside
Calculation	Add all sides	Multiply Length $\times$ Width

THE RIBBON AND THE PAPER:

If you want to put a ribbon around a card, you measure Perimeter. If you want to paint the whole card, you measure Area!

Area in Your Daily Life

You can see Area being measured everywhere in India!

- **1. Floor Tiles:** Watch a mason laying tiles on a floor. He needs to know the area to buy the right number of tiles.
- **2. Postage Stamps:** A stamp covers a small area on an envelope. A bigger letter might need a bigger stamp (more area!).

- **3. The Chess Board:** A standard chess board has 64 small squares. The area of the board is exactly 64 square units!
- **4. Tiffin Box Lids:** Your tiffin lid covers the top of your food. A larger tiffin has a lid with a larger area.

Interactive Practice: The Tiffin Lid Challenge

Let's use our formula to find the area of these three tiffin lids!

LID A: SMALL SNACK BOX

Length: 4 units | Width: 3 units

Area = _____ square units

LID B: LUNCH BOX

Length: 8 units | Width: 5 units

Area = _____ square units

LID C: SQUARE SWEET BOX

Length: 6 units | Width: 6 units

Area = _____ square units

Summary: The Tile Master's Checklist

Fantastic job today! You are officially a Tile Master. Let's remember the core ideas:

- Area is the space inside a shape.
- You can find area by counting unit squares on a grid.
- The shortcut formula for a rectangle is **Length × Width**.
- Area covers a surface (like grass), while perimeter goes around a boundary (like a fence).

Keep Measuring!

Try to find gridded surfaces around you today—like bathroom tiles or a window screen—and count the area!